

KAVEEN UPEKA

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Work Rights (485 Visa)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Master of Business Information Systems graduate (Swinburne University, 2025) with a First Class Honours degree in International Management and Business (University of Plymouth). Brings 3+ years of international experience in project coordination, stakeholder engagement, and strategic communications across agency, startup, and non-profit environments. Adept at translating complex technical requirements for non-technical stakeholders and driving cross-functional team alignment. Seeking a role in project coordination, business analysis, or project management in Melbourne.

EDUCATION

Master of Business Information Systems

Graduated August 2025

Swinburne University of Technology, Melbourne, Australia

- Key focus areas: Data visualisation, Project management, Agile methodologies
- Capstone project: Delivered a multi-phase book sorting solution for 123Read2Me (a non-profit with 1M+ book donations), bridging technical and non-technical stakeholders

Bachelor of International Management and Business — First Class Honours

Graduated August 2022

University of Plymouth, UK

- Key modules: Strategic communications, Marketing, Project management

CIM Postgraduate Diploma in Professional Marketing

Graduated June 2023

Chartered Institute of Marketing (CIM), UK

Diploma in International Relations

Graduated March 2022

Bandaranaike Centre for International Studies (BCIS), Sri Lanka

WORK EXPERIENCE

Note: Relocated to Melbourne in mid-2023 to undertake full-time Master's studies at Swinburne University.

Account Manager | MullenLowe Sri Lanka

Jan 2023 – June 2023

- Managed a portfolio of Unilever brands (Sunsilk, Lux, TreSemmé) across integrated campaign cycles, ensuring on-time delivery and budget adherence
- Co-wrote television commercials (TVCs) that increased audience engagement for a leading FMCG brand, contributing to measurable uplift in brand recall
- Recruited directly based on outstanding performance delivering a nationally recognised PSA campaign at NGage Strategic Alliance

PR Executive → Account Manager | NGage Strategic Alliance, Sri Lanka

July 2021 – Dec 2022

- Managed public relations for key clients including Cathay Pacific and Sysco Labs, coordinating press conferences and maintaining relationships with leading English-language media outlets
- Transitioned into ATL account management, leading end-to-end campaign planning and execution for multiple FMCG brands simultaneously
- Built and maintained a media contact network of 20+ journalists and editors, improving client press coverage turnaround times

Strategist | Drakon Solutions (Startup)

March 2020 – April 2021

- Developed tailored go-to-market and recovery strategies for 10+ SMBs navigating pandemic-related disruption, contributing to measurable improvements in sales pipeline activity
- Delivered copywriting, creative direction, and strategic recommendations in a lean startup environment, demonstrating adaptability across multiple concurrent workstreams

PROJECTS & LEADERSHIP

Capstone Project: Book Sorting Solution | [Swinburne University of Technology](#)

2025

- Partnered with 123Read2Me, a Melbourne-based non-profit that has donated over 1 million books to reduce poverty through literacy
- Led stakeholder communication for a team of 5, translating complex technical solutions for a predominantly non-tech-savvy workforce (avg. age 60+), driving stakeholder buy-in for a multi-phase implementation
- Applied project management frameworks (requirements gathering, solution scoping, phased delivery planning) to produce a structured project recommendation

Founder & Secretary — One Stage for All | [South Asia's largest charity for Down Syndrome & Autism](#)

2018 – 2019

- Co-founded a large-scale charity initiative as a school leaver, scaling the event from a team of 20 to 600+ children and 2,000+ participants within 5 months
- Built and led a volunteer force of 1,000+, demonstrating large-scale stakeholder coordination, recruitment, and community engagement
- Secured significant fundraising outcomes and sustained multi-year organisational impact across follow-on projects

SKILLS

Project & Business Analysis

Agile / Scrum • Requirements gathering • Stakeholder management • Process mapping • Risk management • Business case development • JIRA (familiar) • Project lifecycle management

Data & Analytics

Power BI • Tableau • Google Analytics • MS Excel (advanced) • AWS Cloud (foundational) • CRM systems

Communication & Tools

Stakeholder & executive communication • Cross-cultural team leadership • Public speaking • MS Office Suite (Word, PowerPoint, Excel) • Culturally diverse team environments

REFEREES

DR.Stuart McLoughlin

Lecturer, Information Systems

School of Business, Law and Entrepreneurship

Swinburne University of Technology - Hawthorn Victoria

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